



The Ultimate Distro Showdown

It's (K)Ubuntu 9.10 vs openSUSE 11.2 vs Mandriva 2010.

We laid our hands on all the three biggies—Ubuntu 9.10, Mandriva 2010 and openSUSE 11.2—and pitted them against each other. What followed was the battle of the century, as each distro pulled off one unique trick after another to stay on top of the game.

Ladies and gentlemen, behold, as we bring out the next generation of Linux-based operating systems, and try to find out which one has that little extra to make the cut as the best of the best!

The hardware

- *Processor:* AMD Phenom X3 8650 @ 2.3GHz
- *Chipset:* Nvidia MCP67 (nForce 630a)
- *Graphics Processor:* Nvidia GeForce 9400GT with 1GB of GDDR2 RAM
- *RAM:* 2GB of DDR2 800MHz Transcend JetRAM
- *Hard Disk:* Seagate Barracuda 320GB/Western Digital Caviar 160GB (hosts the OS)
- *Screen:* 15" TFT with a resolution of 1024x768

That's a pretty respectable multimedia PC, except for the rather small screen size. However, it shouldn't matter, because if the UI looks cluttered on my monitor, then the UI design is bad. Anyway, with the hardware specs behind us, it's time to move on to the first distro of this review—Ubuntu 9.10.